LINKEDIN- CASE STUDY



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PROBLEM STATEMENT

"LinkedIn, while widely adopted, fails to comprehensively address the full spectrum of problems faced by its target users—especially around meaningful networking, authentic hiring, and skill-based visibility. There is a growing need for a differentiated platform that identifies these pain points and provides targeted, outcome-driven solutions outside of the traditional LinkedIn experience."

LINKEDIN

PROBLEMS FACED BY STUDENTS

- **Discoverability & Visibility**

-Hard to stand out due to algorithm bias favoring influencers or people with large networks
-Profile views don’t translate to meaningful connections or opportunities

- **Job Search Frustration**

-Spam or “ghost” job postings (positions that don’t actually exist)
-Companies post jobs but don’t actively respond or provide feedback
-Irrelevant job suggestions due to vague filtering

- **Networking Difficulties**

-Cold messages are often ignored or flagged
-Genuine outreach is lost among spammy DMs
--Networking feels transactional, not relational

- **Skill Signaling & Validation**:

-No structured way to showcase hands-on work (e.g., projects, hackathons, GitHub links)

- **Content Pressure**

-Feed dominated by viral or motivational posts rather than learning-driven content
-Fear of judgment or rejection for posting technical or niche content

- **Lack of Guidance**

-No mentorship discovery or structured peer learning
-Overwhelming amount of self-promotion makes it hard to find real guidance

PROBLEMS FACED BY PROFESSIONALS

- **Superficial Connections**

-Connections made for reach, not value — resulting in weak ties
-Low engagement in meaningful discussions or collaboration

- **Spam & Sales Pitches**

-Flooded with irrelevant pitches from recruiters, salespeople, and service providers
-InMail is often misused and ineffective

- **Recruitment Gaps**

-Recruiters struggle to find genuinely skilled candidates due to inflated resumes
--No easy way to validate real experience or project-based skills

- **Brand Pressure**

-Platform rewards people who are constantly "visible" — pressuring professionals to post or engage just to stay relevant
-Those who don’t “perform” on LinkedIn feel left behind, despite actual competence

- **Poor Targeting**

-Ads and content recommendations often irrelevant to user’s actual domain
-Hard to filter by nuanced professional interests

USER PERSONA



Ramesh | 21 | Kanpur | IIT Student

Wants to connect with diverse crowd of students globally and brain storm about startups

Pain Points

- Finds it hard to meaningful connects from where he can learn.
- Linkedin does not provide a platform for like-minded learners(the community groups are usually spam)
- No overall growth in his interested field

Needs

- A good peer group
- Limitation of random connections
- Skill growth which leads to career growth



Rekha | 36 | Banglore | Homemaker

Took a career break for a few years and now looking for jobs

Pain Points

- Majority entry level opportunities.
- Finds it difficult to connect with people and socialize.
- Falls for fake job postings and offers
- Gets ghosted and ignored by the recruiters
- Inspite of having a lot of experience in past, finds it hard to portray it

Needs

- Legitimate and senior level jon openings
- Reduction of spam accounts
- More interactive platform
- Better exhibition of skills

TARGET SEGMENT

Students and early-career professionals (ages 18–26) in Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities who are actively preparing for internships, job placements, and looking forward to upskill for the same

PROBLEM FRAMING CANVAS

CUSTOMER SURVEY INSIGHTS

- 79% of job applicants never hear back after applying on LinkedIn leading to frustration
- Only 25% of LinkedIn users are active monthly.
- 45% of Gen Z users feel anxious about posting, due to fear of judgment and pressure to perform.
- 94% of recruiters receive irrelevant applications,
- 71% of users report receiving spam or sales messages, degrading networking quality and trust.
- No built-in system for collective or peer learning, leaving students isolated in their upskilling journey.

PROBLEMS

- Job feature is not helping the recruiters as well as the people applying efficiently.
- No platform for open discussion for flow of ideas and collective collaboration
- Not able to display skills and prove their authenticity
- Lack of Contextual Identity as everyone looks the same

WHO IS FACING THIS PROBLEM

Students and early-career professionals (ages 18–26) in Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities who are actively preparing for internships, job placements and wanting to upskill

Problem Breakdown

WHAT IS THE TRUE PROBLEM

LinkedIn is built around individual profiles and one-directional content, not collective growth or shared experiences

WHY DO WE KNOW IT IS A REAL PROBLEM

LinkedIn fails to support micro-communities where students and early professionals can grow through collaboration, peer feedback, and shared accountability

WHY SOLVE IT NOW

With Gen Z entering the workforce and cohort-based learning on the rise, there's a timely need for a platform that enables structured, skill-based peer ecosystems.

VALUE GENERATED FOR USERS

- Peer-Powered Growth
- Real Visibility Through Projects-Instead of relying on polished resumes, users build credibility by showcasing collaboration in real-time skill groups and challenges.
- Supportive, Safe Space for Career Development
- Removing the fear and pressure of posting

VALUE GENERATED FOR BUSINESS

- High Engagement & Retention
- Unique Monetization Paths-Premium cohorts, mentor subscriptions, verified peer learning badges, and recruiter tools create multiple monetization streams.
- Powerful Network Effects

LINKEDIN SHORTCOMINGS

Feature	What It Does	**Shortcoming**
News Feed	Shows user-generated posts, company updates, job changes	Overrun by motivational spam and personal stories. The algorithm rewards engagement, not value. Content is not personalized by don
Job Search	Aggregates job listings and allows filtering by role, location, etc.	Filled with ghost job postings that aren't actively hiring. Lacks a feedback loop for applications. High volume but low relevance.
InMail and Messaging	Enables direct messaging and cold outreach	Often used for spam and sales pitches. Cold messages are ignored by recruiters. No intelligent templates or messaging suggestions.
Connections and Networking	Allows users to connect and build professiona l networks	Connections rarely lead to meaningful relationships. No indicator of connection strength or interaction quality. Interactions are shallo
Endorsements	Lets users validate each other’s skills	Can be easily gamed. Not a credible signal of ability. Lacks proof or demonstration of the skill being endorsed.
Recommendations	Users write testimonials for others	Most recommendations are generic and biased. No way to verify accuracy. Not tagged to specific projects or outcomes.
Creator Mode	Boosts post visibility and supports content creators	Encourages performative posting and personal branding over substance. Benefits influencers more than subject matter experts. Poor disc
Learning Platform	Offers a library of professional development courses	Content is generic and lacks interactivity. No way to validate learning through application. Missing integration with mentors or peer learning.
Profile System	Serves as a digital resume with work history and education	Too text-heavy and static. Doesn't showcase real-world projects or outcomes. Not designed for students or early-career professionals without formal job history.

IDEATION OF SOLUTION & FEATURES

Solution Idea	Feature Name	Feature Description
Enable structured peer learning	Goal-Based Micro-Cohorts	Small, curated groups based on shared goals (e.g., resume building, case prep) with set timelines, tasks, and cohort milestones.
Build real collaboration, not just connections	Project Pods	Members co-create capstone projects or challenges inside a dedicated space, visible to mentors and recruiters.
Ensure accountability and motivation	Progress Tracker & Check-ins	Cohort dashboard where members log updates, track milestones, and get automated or peer nudges to stay on track.
Replace spammy messaging with meaningful interaction	Cohort Wall	A private discussion board for each cohort to ask questions, share wins, or get help — without the pressure of public posting.
Facilitate real-time peer support and feedback	Peer Feedback Loops	Structured peer review sessions (weekly or milestone-based) with templates for constructive critique on resumes, projects, etc.
Match people intelligently, not randomly	Smart Peer Matchmaking	AI-based system that pairs users into cohorts by skill level, time zone, goal, and learning style for maximum synergy.
Include mentors without friction	AMA Mentor Hours	Mentors or industry pros drop into active cohorts to answer questions and review work in casual, low-pressure formats.

PRIORITIZATION

Must Have

- Goal-Based Micro-Cohorts
- Cohort Wall
- Progress Tracker & Check-ins

Should have

- Smart Peer Matchmaking
- Project Pods

Could have

- Peer Feedback Loops
- AMA Mentor Hours

Won’t have

Public Profile Pages / Recruiter Access

GTM STRATEGY

Problem Statement: A focused, clutter-free platform for students to learn, build, and grow together in small cohorts — no noise, no algorithm, just real progress with real peers.”

Channel	Tactic	Why It Works
Campus Ambassadors	Partner with 10–15 high-engagement students per college to recruit cohorts	Trusted messengers; insider access to active learners
Telegram & Discord Takeovers	Join existing prep groups and run value-driven activities (e.g., resume roast week, peer challenge)	Your users are already here. You meet them in their space.
LinkedIn & Instagram Content	Post stories from live cohorts, transformation snapshots, peer wins	Build trust + FOMO through real stories
Referral Loop	Offer early access or bonus features when users invite 3+ peers into a cohort	Viral loop built into student behavior
Micro-Influencer UGC	Collaborate with niche creators on YouTube/IG for authentic walk-throughs	Low cost, high trust for Gen Z

THANK YOU !

